

THE JADEJA JUGGERNAUT AND THE TRUE ALL-ROUNDER OF THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Our correspondents bring you all the **thrilling action**, both on and off the field, from round six of the 2024-25 Ranji Trophy season.

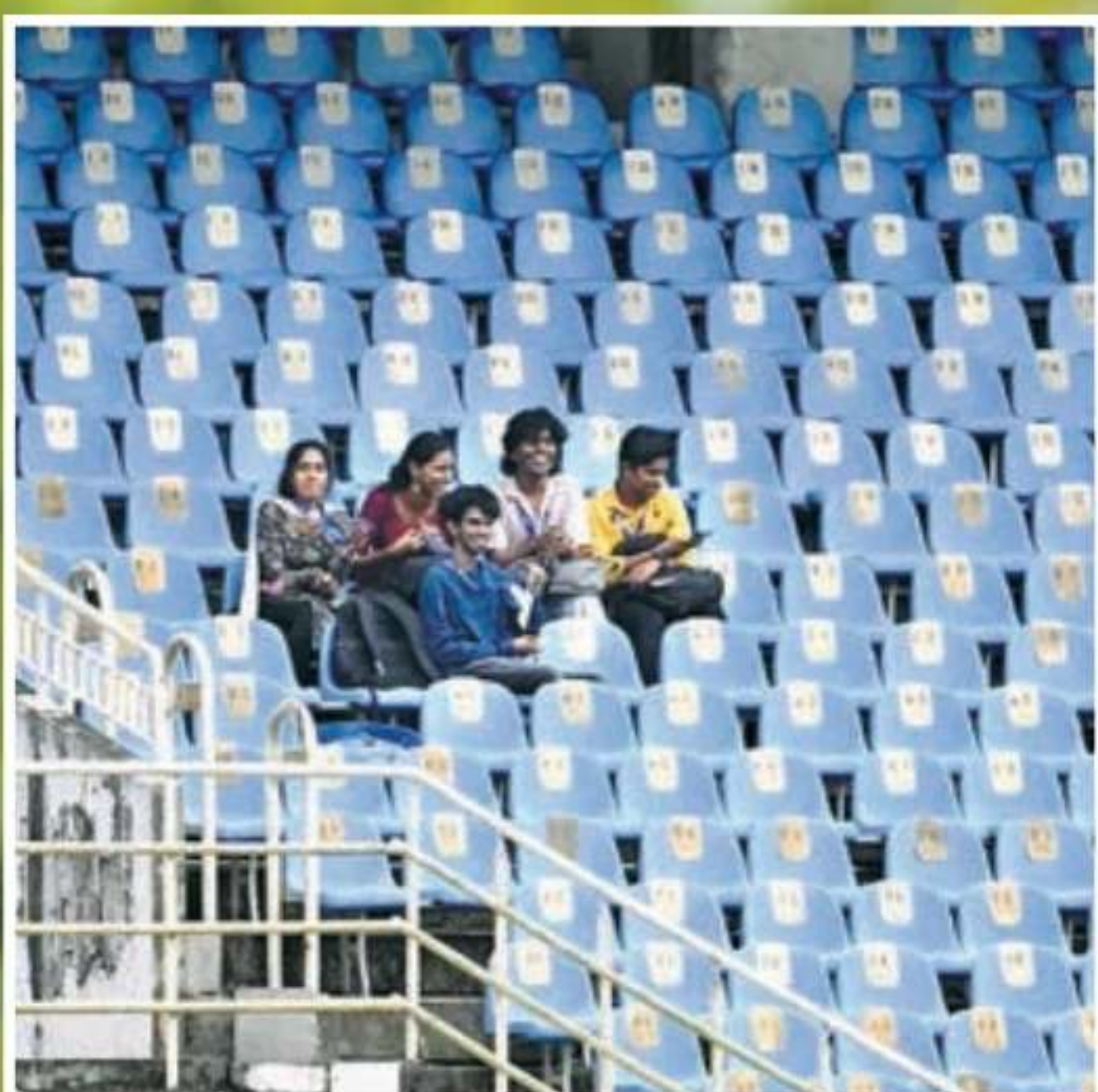
Ravindra Jadeja's reputation as a skilled left-arm spinner and batter is well-established. The 36-year-old India star showcased his brilliance again, taking 12 wickets and scoring a quickfire 38 on a turning track. His all-round heroics powered Saurashtra to a bonus-point victory over Delhi in just two days during the sixth round of the Ranji Trophy, which began on January 23 in Rajkot.

Flying under the radar in Saurashtra's emphatic win was Dharmendrasinh Jadeja, who contributed with five wickets. Among his victims in the first innings was the

dangerous Rishabh Pant, who mistimed a sweep shot and was caught at deep square leg.

The spotlight, often eluding Dharmendrasinh, has been a recurring theme in his long-standing career. At 34, he has taken 380 wickets in 91 First-Class matches at an average of 26.77. Like many outstanding left-arm spinners before him — such as Rajinder Goel and Padmakar Shivalkar, who never got the chance to represent India — Dharmendrasinh has had to accept the harsh reality of being overlooked.

"It does cross my mind sometimes why I haven't



Empty stadium: Kerala fought for a crucial draw, nearly reaching the Ranji knockout phase for the first time in six years, but had little crowd support.

NIRMAL HARINDRAN

